

Other

Other

Your 90-Day Output Number

Now it's time for a dose of reality. In the space provided below, take your 90-Day Input Number and subtract from it your 90-Day Output Number.

Your 90-Day Input Number

Your 90-Day Output Number

Your 90-Day Number

Write that 90-Day Number down. Is it a positive number or a negative one? If you're taking in more money than you spend, congratulations! You're the rare person who has a positive financial outlook. Whatever you're doing, keep it up. Now, there's still the matter of maximizing your money's efficiency, eliminating uncertainties and putting that excellent surplus to better use—namely, saving for emergencies. I'll teach you how to do all of that in the chapters that follow. Those changes might be challenging at first, but you'll adjust, because you're starting from a place of strength and diligence.

If you don't fit the above profile, maybe you're someone with a number that comes up just slightly above zero. You're getting by with a little extra, especially if you have little saved. But you're not really in the clear. I worry about you because you may never have experienced rock bottom, so you're not really aware of how dangerously close you are to financial jeopardy. That's why I sometimes think that people who have experienced debt, people who have hit rock bottom, have a perverse kind of advantage over others: Their problems are so huge, they simply can't go on ignoring them. But what's best for you, in your